"It Won't Be the Way That **We Are Currently Doing It**"

Madan Pillutla, Dean and Professor of Organisational Behaviour at ISB, on why business schools would have to organise themselves differently in future, as demand for an MBA will become less predictable

BY **SIDDHARTH ZARABI**

Twenty-five years ago, the idea of building a world-class business school in India was an ambitious proposition. Today, the Indian School of Business (ISB) has emerged as a leading management institution, with a global outlook and alumni who have made their mark across industries.

As ISB completes 25 years, the institution stands at an important inflexion point. India's economic landscape is changing rapidly, businesses are navigating new challenges, and expectations from management education are evolving.

In an interview with *Business Today*, Madan Pillutla, Dean and Professor of Organisational Behaviour at ISB, discusses the institution's next phase, the future of management education, the changing MBA model and the capabilities future leaders will need.

Pillutla has been Dean of ISB since July 2021. Before joining ISB, he spent 22 years at London Business School, where he held several leadership positions, including Deputy Dean of Faculty. His research focuses on decision-making, negotiations and behavioural factors that influence choices made by individuals and organisations.

Edited excerpts:

Q: As ISB completes 25 years, how do you reflect on the institution's journey so far?

A: We are living through a period of extraordinary change. The pace of transformation is dramatic, and institutions of higher education are looking at how their models will evolve. The education system, particularly higher education, has remained largely unchanged for many decades, but we believe it will be disrupted in ways that are difficult to fully anticipate.

At the same time, the engine of growth has moved eastwards. India is uniquely positioned among major economies because growth is continuing and we have a young population that can be trained and retrained as new technologies emerge.